

POKER NIGHT

Detailed Product Guide

A clear, non-technical explanation of what Poker Night does and how people use it

MVP Scope v2.0

Web-first MVP • One administrator • Tournament + minimal cash mode • No Spotify

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1. What Poker Night Is

Poker Night is a website that helps one person organise and run a private Texas Hold'em game. It is designed for home poker nights where the host currently has to manage messages, attendance, chips, blinds, a timer, rebuys, seating and prizes manually.

The host gives Poker Night a small amount of information. The app then prepares a tournament that fits the number of people, the available time and the physical chips that actually exist in the host's poker set.

The simple idea

The host decides what kind of poker night they want. Poker Night handles the organisation and suggests the structure. The host always makes the final decision.

2. Who Uses It

Administrator

There is one administrator for each game. This is usually the host. The administrator creates the game, chooses the settings, confirms guests, starts the timer and records everything that happens during the tournament.

Registered player

A registered player can join the private group, answer invitations, use chat and polls, receive notifications, check in and view the live tournament from their phone.

Guest

A guest does not need an account. They open the tournament website with a code or QR link, select who invited them, choose the correct guest slot and enter their name. After the host confirms them, they can see their table, seat, timer and other basic game information. Guests cannot use chat or polls unless they create an account.

3. What Is Included Now

- One responsive website that works on phones, tablets, laptops and TV browsers.
- Private groups, invitations, guest places and check-in.
- An automatic tournament generator based on players, duration and chips.
- A live timer with blinds, ante, players remaining and average stack.
- Rebuys, add-ons, knockouts, seating and final-table redraw.
- A private prize calculator for the host.
- A public TV page opened with a code or link.
- Simple English voice announcements.
- Group chat, polls and browser/in-app notifications.
- Group game history and a few simple player statistics.
- A basic cash-game section.

What is not included in the first version

- Spotify
- Native iPhone and Android apps
- Built-in Chromecast or AirPlay buttons
- More than one administrator per game
- Advanced player graphs and financial statistics
- Complex social features or achievements
- Payment processing

- Advanced cash-game rules

4. How a Tournament Works



The main tournament journey

Step 1 — Create the game

The host enters the name, date, starting time, location, expected number of players, buy-in and desired duration. The normal duration is 3.5 hours, but the host can choose from 3 to 6 hours in half-hour steps.

Step 2 — Describe the chips

The host can choose a saved chip set, enter the exact number of every chip, or use a faster setup. In the fast setup, they choose the available colours and arrange them from most available to least available. If the chips have no printed numbers, Poker Night suggests a different value for each colour.

Step 3 — Choose optional rules

The host can enable rebuys, an add-on, a knockout bounty and an ante. Rebuys normally close at the end of Level 6. An add-on is available once per active player. If an ante is used, big blind ante is the normal choice.

Step 4 — Receive the proposal

Poker Night suggests the starting stack, exact chips in each stack, opening blinds, every future blind level, level duration, rebuy stacks, add-on amount, chip exchanges, expected finish and prize distribution. The host reviews the proposal and can regenerate or edit it before confirming.

Step 5 — Invite people

Registered players receive the game invitation and choose one answer: Going, Maybe, Can't Come, Going +1, Going +2, Going +3 or Going +4. The guest number is part of the answer, not a separate question.

Step 6 — Check in and sit down

Players can check themselves in, or the host can do it. Guests use the shared code, select the person who invited them and choose an unused guest place. The host confirms the guest. Poker Night then prepares the tables and seats.

Step 7 — Run the tournament

The host starts the timer. Every connected player and TV sees the same current blinds and remaining time. Only the host can pause, continue, record eliminations, grant rebuys or add-ons, and confirm seat moves.

Step 8 — Close rebuys and handle add-ons

When the last rebuy level finishes, the timer pauses. There is no fixed break countdown. The host takes as much time as needed to record final rebuys, choose who purchased an add-on, exchange old chips and confirm the ante. No new players may join after this moment. The host starts the next level when everyone is ready.

Step 9 — Final table and result

If the game had more than one table, Poker Night pauses when nine players remain and creates a completely new random final-table seating plan. It also chooses the initial dealer position. At the end, the host records the finishing order and publishes the podium. Players never see prize amounts after the game.

5. How the Automatic Structure Works

Poker Night does not force every game to start with the same stack or blinds. A stack of 5,000 can be deep at 25/50, but far too deep at 5/10. The app therefore solves the stack and blinds together.

It first checks which blind values are easy to pay with the available chips. A blind such as 20/50 is acceptable when it is simpler than 25/50. The small blind does not always have to be exactly half the big blind. The important thing is that players can follow the numbers easily and post the blinds without constant change.

Every level lasts exactly 10, 15 or 20 minutes. Normally, the complete tournament uses one level duration. The app estimates how many levels fit inside the chosen duration, how quickly blinds need to grow and roughly when the tournament should end.

Changes during the game

The host can still change the future structure during play. Poker Night can estimate that the tournament is finishing too early or too late and suggest speeding up or slowing down. A speed-up can shorten future levels or add an ante. A slow-down can make future levels longer or add an extra intermediate blind level. The active level never changes, and the host must approve every adjustment.

6. Invitations and Guests

Every group has a private code. Every tournament also has a code and shareable link. The tournament page offers a normal player route, a guest route and a TV display route.

Guest example

1. Maria answers Going +2.
2. Her two friends open the tournament link.
3. Each friend chooses Maria as the inviter.
4. One chooses Maria's Guest 1 and the other chooses Guest 2.
5. They enter their names and request check-in.
6. The host confirms both guests.
7. Each guest receives a table and seat on the website.

Players may change their attendance response until one hour before the game. The host can still manage attendance before late registration closes. After the rebuy period ends, nobody new can enter.

7. Running the Game

What the host sees

- Large timer and level controls
- Current and next blinds
- Player list and seating
- Buttons for elimination, rebuy and add-on
- Estimated finishing time
- Speed Up, Slow Down and Edit Future Levels
- Prize calculation and chip-exchange instructions
- Undo/correction controls

What players see

- Timer, blinds and ante
- Next level
- Players remaining

- Average stack
- Their own seat
- Announcements
- The total Prize Pool while the game is active

Players do not see who rebought, who purchased an add-on, the organizer percentage or individual payout amounts.

Recovery if something goes wrong

The host's browser saves the active tournament on the device. If the page refreshes or the internet disappears temporarily, the host can restore the timer and game state. Other players and TVs need an internet connection and show the last known information until they reconnect.

8. TV and Voice

TV Mode is simply a clean website page. The host opens it on a TV browser with the code or mirrors it from another device. There is no special Spotify or casting integration in the first version.

- Large timer
- Current blinds and ante
- Next level
- Players remaining
- Average stack
- Prize Pool during the game
- Announcements
- Final-table seating and final podium

The host manually chooses one device to speak. It uses a normal English browser voice for announcements such as a new level, five minutes remaining, one minute remaining, rebuys closed, final table, dealer position and winner. Eliminated-player names are optional and off by default.

9. Chat, Polls and Notifications

Chat

Registered members have a simple group chat and can also have a chat connected to a specific tournament. Guests cannot use chat. The host can remove inappropriate messages.

Polls

The host can ask members to vote on the date, start time, buy-in, knockout format, duration, location or another question. Poll results can help Poker Night suggest a saved tournament preset.

Notifications

Players receive an in-app notification and, when their browser allows it, a browser push notification. Examples include a new tournament, an RSVP deadline, a new poll, a confirmed seat and a game starting soon.

10. History and Statistics

The group keeps a simple list of completed games. Members can see the date, game name, attendance and final positions. They do not see prize amounts.

The first version keeps only five basic player statistics: games played, wins, podium finishes, average finish and knockouts. It does not include personal profit, ROI, detailed rebuy history, graphs or a separate personal game-history page.

11. Cash Games



The simpler cash-game journey

Cash Poker is a separate, much simpler section. The host creates a session with fixed blinds, adds players and seats them, and starts a normal time counter. The blinds do not increase.

The host records the chip value issued as each player's buy-in and any later top-ups. When a player leaves, the host enters the final chip value returned. At the end, Poker Night checks that the total value issued matches the total value returned.

These records describe chips, not whether anyone actually paid cash. Poker Night does not process or confirm payments. Advanced cash features such as waiting lists, multiple tables, straddles and long-term profit statistics are postponed.

12. What Is Intentionally Postponed

- Native mobile apps
- Spotify
- Dedicated Chromecast and AirPlay integration
- Several administrators controlling one game
- Premium voice packs and voice commands
- Friends, feeds, achievements and seasons
- Advanced statistics and financial player profiles
- Complete offline use on every device
- Payment processing
- Advanced cash-game options

These features can be added later without changing the central idea. The first version should prove that Poker Night can organise a group, create a practical tournament from real chips, run it reliably and display it clearly.

13. Example Poker Night

Daniel creates "Friday Poker" for eight people, with a 15 buy-in, a 3.5-hour duration and rebuys until Level 6. He chooses an unnumbered chip set with white, red, blue and black chips and ranks them by availability.

Poker Night recommends values for each colour, a starting stack, the chips in each stack, 15-minute levels and a complete blind structure. Daniel checks the proposal and publishes the game. Six members choose Going, one chooses Going +1 and one chooses Maybe.

On Friday, the guest opens the link, selects the inviter and claims the guest slot. Daniel confirms everyone and accepts random seating. He opens TV Mode on the television and selects it as the voice device.

During Level 6, one player is eliminated and receives a rebuy. When the level ends, Poker Night pauses. Daniel records two add-ons, follows the suggested chip exchanges and confirms that the big blind ante begins next. The game is running twenty-five minutes late, so Poker Night offers shorter future levels. Daniel previews and accepts the change.

When nine players would remain in a larger two-table example, the app would redraw the final table. In this eight-player game, it continues on the original table. Daniel records the final order and publishes the podium. The group history updates, but nobody sees the prize amounts.

What the first version must feel like

A host who understands a normal home poker game should be able to create and run a tournament without understanding software architecture or tournament mathematics. The system explains its recommendation, and the host stays in charge.